

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1516

By Littleton

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend former United States Congressman Robert Nelson Clement for his distinguished service to the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those distinguished citizens whose lives of public service and leadership have profoundly enriched the State of Tennessee and the nation; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Robert Nelson Clement, known to all as Bob Clement, who has devoted his life to public service with a steadfast commitment to the people of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, born September 23, 1943, in Nashville, Congressman Clement is the eldest son of former Governor Frank Goad Clement and First Lady Lucille Christianson Clement, from whom he inherited a deep appreciation for civic duty, public leadership, and the enduring values of service; and

WHEREAS, in 1972, at the remarkable age of twenty-nine, Bob Clement was elected to the Tennessee Public Service Commission, becoming the youngest statewide elected official in the history of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, in 1979, he was appointed by President Jimmy Carter to serve on the Board of Directors of the Tennessee Valley Authority, where he contributed to the advancement of one of the nation's most significant public utilities and economic development engines; and

WHEREAS, from 1983 to 1987, Congressman Clement served as President of Cumberland University in Lebanon, where he provided visionary leadership, guiding the institution's transformation into a four-year, fully accredited university and strengthening its role as a center of higher education in the region; and

WHEREAS, in 1988, he was elected to the United States House of Representatives from Tennessee's Fifth Congressional District and went on to serve eight consecutive terms, from January 19, 1989, to January 3, 2003, earning widespread respect for his bipartisan approach, dedication to his constituents, and advocacy for infrastructure, education, veterans, and economic development; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure in Congress, Congressman Clement served with distinction on key committees and was widely regarded as a thoughtful and effective legislator who placed the interests of Tennessee above partisan considerations; and

WHEREAS, following his retirement from Congress in 2003, Bob Clement continued his lifelong commitment to public service and historic preservation, particularly in his beloved home of Davidson County and nearby Dickson County; and

WHEREAS, he was instrumental in the creation and development of the Clement Railroad Hotel Museum at the Hotel Halbrook State Historic Site in Dickson, helping to preserve the historic birthplace of Governor Frank G. Clement and ensuring that future generations may learn from and be inspired by Tennessee's rich history; and

WHEREAS, Congressman Clement served as the Museum's first Board Chair, providing critical leadership during its formative years, and continues to serve the institution with distinction as President Emeritus and Chair of Development, demonstrating his unwavering dedication to historical preservation, education, and community engagement; and

WHEREAS, throughout his life, Bob Clement has exemplified integrity, leadership, and a deep love for the people of Tennessee, securing an enduring legacy that will continue to inspire generations to come; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly acknowledge this esteemed gentleman; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and commend former United States Congressman Robert Nelson Clement for his extraordinary career in public service, his lasting contributions to the State of Tennessee, and his continued dedication to preserving our shared history. We extend to him our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.